



Acer joins the All-in-one PC game with their Aspire Z5610 with a 24-inch multi-touch HD screen



MSI's Wind Nettop gets a make-over, with existing specs inside - Intel Atom, 1 GB RAM, 160GB HDD

paired via Bluetooth, the range won't cover your entire house, but a nifty feature to have nonetheless.

Acer (Aspire X1800, Aspire IE3530 and Aspire IE4750)

The Aspire X1800 has a cute little cabinet. It should fit in nicely on any crowded desk. Despite its small size, the X1800 has a plethora of ports. An eSATA port, surprisingly not seen on most other models, is available on this one. The keyboard, other than decent tactility, also offered a nifty volume knob at the corner. The mouse also is quite ergonomic thanks to its slightly arc-shaped design.

The other two Acer models (the Aspire IE3530 and Aspire IE4750) are full-sized cabinets. But unlike the plain-jane looks that other manufacturers chose, Acer's well-built cabinets have a distinct designer top. Also at the top are four USB ports which will be nifty for people who keep their cabinet under the table. Lastly, the power button is placed at the top corner, the design reminding us of the Acer Revo we tested last month.

All three models come with the same set of stereo speakers. Unlike the ones bundled with Intex PCs, Acer's desktop series are powered via USB and with a standard 3.5-mm port to connect to the PC. They give out quite decent audio quality with stereo output.

Zenith (E7500 and E8400)

The offerings from Zenith are also quite simplistic in terms of design. They also come

HOW WE TESTED

The desktop PC test had a lot of factors to keep in mind. The tests consisted of the usual desktop application benchmarks using PC Mark 2005 and 3D Mark 2006. Slightly older versions were used so that the really slow net top machines didn't have a major disadvantage. Most of the desktops we were expecting didn't belong to any high-end or gaming desktops lineups. We also used SiSoft Sandra as our synthetic benchmark for the memory benchmark.

The proper real world test

scores came from Cinebench which any day is one of the best to measure performance of multicore processors. WinRAR also measures CPU and memory performance. Most users would use their desktops for converting media and the 100 MB DivX file conversion test would tell us exactly how good these systems were at it. The hard drives were stressed by transferring large 4 GB of assorted files. For games, the trusty Doom 3 benchmark would still be valid - a great refined one.

Of course, scores and numbers aren't all. We would use the desktops to get an idea of the quality of the keyboard and mice. We were expecting monitors with built-in webcams and so we would take down scores for it as well. The same went with the speakers. Also, we gave points for all the features that the desktops came with - number of expansion slots and USB ports, etc.

For the Apple Macs, we had to use a different set of benchmarks - Geekbench and Cinebench R10.



Acer Aspire IE 4750

with a simple keyboard and mouse. The desktop comes with a very basic cabinet, very small and doesn't have too not much excitement. It's a standard designed used on many of their other desktops. The system configuration is decent and the performance in the benchmarks better than some of the more expensive products we've received. The

keyboard is basic and is good enough for most text related there. It's not meant for gaming or anything of that sort. For Rs. 20,000, you get a speedy Core 2 Duo E7500 with 2 GB of memory, and a 18.5-inch display. If you're just looking for a basic desktop to use at home to browse the internet or a PC to do accounting and some data entry, you'll find



Zenith E7500

very few choices like this. The costliest model we received came with a similar configuration but with an Intel Core 2 Duo E8400 processor.

Apple iMacs

The pioneer in the genre of all-in-one desktops, the latest iMacs are still popular within the circles. Recent additions to the series included bodies being carved out of the same aluminum used to build MacBook Pros. This gives the iMac a sturdy feel and a cool, exquisite look that's hard to miss. They have an internal power adapter, as only a single power cable draws from the back of the machine. The screen, which encases the PC internals, rests suspending on a stand. They are easily titable off the axis to roughly 20 degrees. A slot loading DVD writer (dubbed the SuperDrive) lies at the right. All the ports and the power button have been placed at the bottom at the back. This is somewhat inconvenient, as one has to peek behind the machine to add/remove anything. The thin isolated-design keyboard offers a good typing experience. Due to the removal of